

CHAPTER 02

Prepare a car that is ready

A vehicle check connects what you notice with what you do next. Finding a defect is useful only if you recognise its significance, avoid an unsafe journey and obtain the right help.

In this chapter

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Answers and review guidance

Official references

This material is a learning aid to help you understand Swedish driving theory. It is not an official source and cannot replace official information from Trafikverket and Transportstyrelsen. Always consult their current guidance and the applicable rules.

Know what the controls tell you

Your goal: Explain the purpose of core controls, warning indicators, braking and steering systems, and identify when further instructions are needed.

The practical test can include checking steering, brakes, tyres, lighting, fluids and warning systems. You should be able to explain why you check them and propose action if you find a problem. Before moving, adjust the seat, head restraint, steering wheel, mirrors and belt.

Trafikverket: safety check

Learning approach. While parked, locate the service brake, parking brake, transmission controls, indicators, lighting controls, wipers, washers, demisting and hazard lights. Explain what each control is for, then demonstrate it with your supervisor. “I can find it” and “I can use it without losing attention” are different learning stages.

The service brake is used to reduce speed and stop; the parking brake helps secure a stationary vehicle. Steering changes the vehicle's direction, but the tyres and road must provide the forces needed to follow that direction. Braking and steering share the available friction: turning the wheel is not proof that the car can follow the intended path. Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§14 and 50 · VTI friction report, section 4.3

Vehicle-specific boundary. Control layouts, warning meanings and system checks differ. Use the instructions for the actual vehicle before trying an unfamiliar function. This material does not prescribe a universal brake-servo test, fluid-opening procedure or response to every dashboard symbol. An unexplained warning is a reason to establish what is wrong before treating the car as ready.

Apply the learning



A learner consults the vehicle handbook beside a parked car. Establish the actual controls before driving; no universal dashboard layout is shown.

Worked decision. Leila starts a borrowed car and sees a warning she cannot identify. Instead of driving to see whether it disappears, she stays parked, consults the vehicle instructions and seeks help. The lesson is to resolve uncertainty, not to guess from a warning's colour alone.

Knowledge check. Does a familiar-looking selector guarantee that an unfamiliar car will behave like your practice car?

Remember: Learn a function, its limitations and the appropriate response—not only its button.

A check before moving

Your goal: Organise a safety check of tyres, lights, visibility and vehicle condition, and distinguish a defect from a reason to seek help.

Learning approach. Work around the car, then through the driving position. Look for damaged tyres, an unusual stance, leaks or obstructions; confirm that windows and mirrors permit a useful view. Check required lights and indicators, and ask for help where a second person is useful. Check washers and wipers before you need them in poor weather. Use the actual vehicle's instructions for fluid levels and service checks. These groups reflect the official practical-test safety check; they are not a guarantee that a quick walkaround detects every defect. Trafikverket: safety check

Requirements. Tyres must be suitable for the vehicle, including load capacity and applicable speed capability. The registration information and approved vehicle requirements matter when changing tyre sizes. Do not assume any wheel that physically fits is suitable. Transportstyrelsen: tyre requirements

Required lighting must work and be used appropriately. Some cars can run daytime lights without rear lights; the driver must ensure suitable front, rear and side lighting is on in darkness, twilight or poor weather. A trailer's lighting must be on during travel. Automatic settings may need manual intervention. Transportstyrelsen: vehicle lighting

Apply the learning



A companion checks the rear of a stationary car and trailer. Check the trailer lights directly before moving.

Worked decision. A passenger notices that the trailer's rear lights are dark although the car's daytime lights are on. The driver checks the setting and connection before moving. “The dashboard looks normal” is not a check of the trailer lamps.

Knowledge check. A tyre has a visible defect, but its tread looks deep. Is tread alone enough to declare it safe?

Remember: Use a repeatable order, then take a specific action for each concern. Detailed winter requirements are in M07-L02.

Protect everyone inside

Your goal: Select suitable restraints for passengers and explain how belts, headrests and airbags work together.

Requirements. In an ordinary car journey, occupants must use an available belt-equipped place and wear the belt. Children under 135 cm normally need an appropriate child restraint. The driver must take appropriate measures to ensure passengers under 15 use the required protection. Limited exceptions exist, including specified short occasional journeys, and should not become a routine travel plan. Seat-belt rules · Traffic Regulation, chapter 4 §§10–10d

For a child aged three or more but shorter than 135 cm, an occasional short transport without an available child restraint is an exception only under the stated conditions: use the belt where possible and not the front seat of a passenger car or light goods vehicle. For a child under three, the exception is an occasional short taxi trip, also excluding the front seat. Plan with the correct restraint instead. Transportstyrelsen: child rules

Official recommendations. Trafikverket recommends rear-facing travel until at least four to five years, preferably longer. Transportstyrelsen's advice says as long as possible, normally around four. These are recommendations, not a single legal birthday on which to turn the seat. Choose equipment that fits the child and car and stays within its approved size and weight limits. Reaching 135 cm does not automatically produce good adult-belt fit. Trafikverket: children in cars · Transportstyrelsen: child protection

Never place a rear-facing child restraint in front of an active passenger airbag. Trafikverket advises at least 140 cm in front of an active airbag unless the manufacturer recommends otherwise; Transportstyrelsen gives more conservative advice for children in restraints. Resolve seating and airbag compatibility using the vehicle and restraint instructions before travelling. An airbag supplements a belt; it does not replace one. Adjust the head restraint for the person occupying the seat. Children in cars · Airbags · Seats and head restraints

Apply the learning



An adult and child stand beside an open rear door. The empty booster and rear bench face forwards. This scene does not demonstrate installation or belt fit; follow the child-restraint and vehicle instructions.

Worked decision. A child reaches the legal height threshold, but the belt still lies badly. The adult checks an appropriate approved booster rather than treating the threshold as an instruction to discard it.

Knowledge check. Can the child use a rear-facing seat in front of an active airbag for a very short trip?

Remember: Legal minimums, official recommendations and equipment compatibility answer different questions.

M02-L04

Move with control

Your goal: Plan observation and control for starting, stopping, reversing, hill starts and turning, and explain why supervised practice is needed.

Requirements. Before moving away from the edge, changing position or lane, you must ensure the movement can be made without danger or unnecessary obstruction. Turning around and reversing must be possible without danger or obstruction to other road users. Signal your intention where required, but a signal does not give you priority. Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§43, 46 and 65–66

Learning approach. Break a manoeuvre into preparation, observation, controlled movement and reassessment. Choose a place with enough room; check around the vehicle and along the intended path; move only while the space remains safe. Stop and reassess when the view changes. Looking once before starting is not continuous observation.

A hill start is a control task: prevent unintended movement while coordinating the actual vehicle's transmission, brakes and accelerator. Do not copy pedal sequences between cars without instruction. Reversing, parking and turning also need practical feedback about vehicle dimensions and the path followed by its corners. The official practical test may examine these skills, including effective braking. Practise braking exercises only in suitable, supervised conditions—not as an experiment in ordinary traffic. Trafikverket: manoeuvring and braking



The driver is in the left-hand seat and looks around before moving. Controls are illustrative; learn the actual vehicle.

Apply the learning



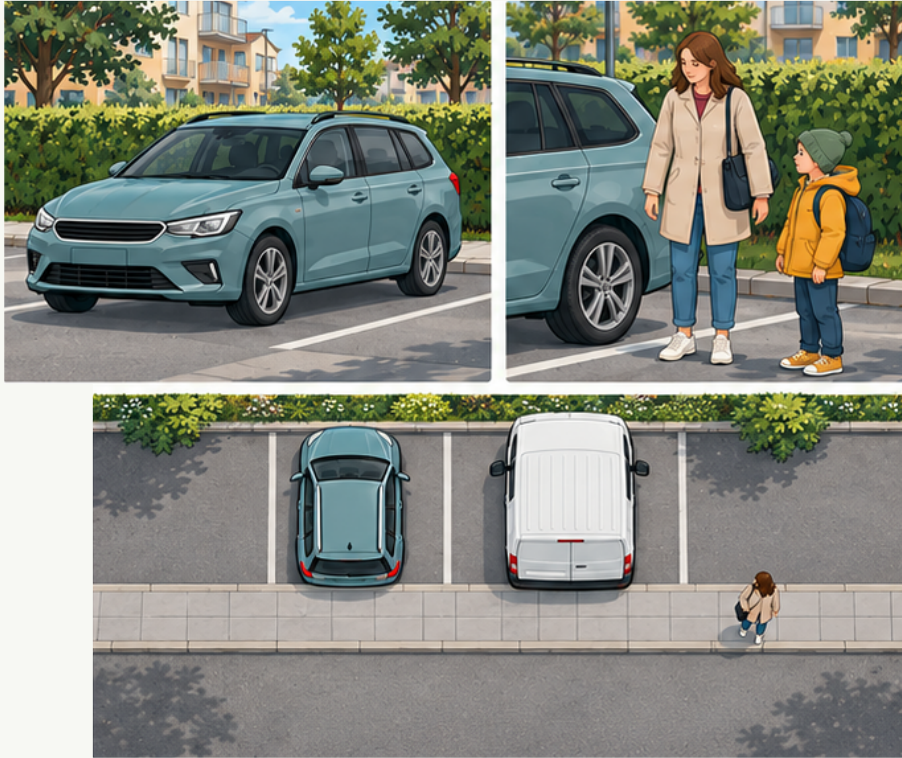
A car and van occupy adjacent bays. A pedestrian is on the footway between the bays and the access lane. Consider what the driver may lose sight of. Diagram not to scale.

Worked decision. While reversing into a space, a driver loses sight of a person who was beside the car. The driver stops. The empty camera image is not enough to resolve where the person went; direct observation and an adequate overall view are still needed.

Knowledge check. If you have signalled and started moving, must another road user always make room?

Remember: Slow control gives you opportunities to observe and stop; it does not remove the need to look.

Review and self-assessment



An unfamiliar car, a child with an adult, and confined parking beside a van. The footway separates the bays from the access lane. No manoeuvre is selected; diagram not to scale.

Scenario: You will drive an unfamiliar car with a child passenger, then reverse out of a confined space.

Describe your preparation and the point at which you would stop and seek help.

Keep a practice record

Record one control or check you can explain but cannot yet perform reliably. Arrange supervised practice and review the result. Syllabus self-assessment, chapter 2 §3

Review after answering

M02-L01

Answer: No. Establish its operation while stationary and practise under suitable supervision.

M02-L02

Answer: No. Condition and suitability also matter. Have the defect assessed and do not make an unsafe journey.

M02-L03

Answer: No. Trip length does not make that arrangement safe.

M02-L04

Answer: No. Your obligation to check safety remains throughout the manoeuvre.

M02-R

Review guide: Establish control operation, vehicle condition, restraint and airbag compatibility, visibility and a safe manoeuvre plan. Do not improvise a technical check or reverse into an uncertain space.

Official references

Official sources checked 4 October 2026. Always consult current official guidance and the applicable rules.

Trafikverket: safety check

<https://www.trafikverket.se/korkort/ta-korkort/personbil-och-latt-lastbil/sa-gar-korprovet-till/>

Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§14 and 50

https://www.riksdagen.se/sv/dokument-och-lagar/dokument/svensk-forfattningssamling/trafikforordning-19981276_sfs-1998-1276/

VTI friction report, section 4.3

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/globalassets/global/regler/jarnvag/plan-och-byggregler-for-vagar-och-sparbunden-trafik/vti-rapport-friktionsegenskaper.pdf>

Transportstyrelsen: tyre requirements

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/fordon/fordonsregler/dack/dackbyte-pa-personbil/>

Official references

Official sources checked 4 October 2026. Always consult current official guidance and the applicable rules.

Transportstyrelsen: vehicle lighting

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/trafikregler-och-vagmarken/trafikregler/generella-trafikregler/fordonsbelysning/>

Seat-belt rules

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/trafikregler-och-vagmarken/trafikregler/i-fordonet/baltesregler/>

Transportstyrelsen: child rules

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/trafikregler-och-vagmarken/trafikregler/i-fordonet/sa-skyddar-du-barnen-regler-och-tips/>

Trafikverket: children in cars

<https://www.trafikverket.se/resa-och-trafik/trafiksakerhet/sakerhet-pa-vag/sakerhet-i-bil/barn-i-bil/>

Official references

Official sources checked 4 October 2026. Always consult current official guidance and the applicable rules.

Airbags

<https://www.trafikverket.se/resa-och-trafik/trafiksakerhet/sakerhet-pa-vag/sakerhet-i-bil/krockkudde/>

Seats and head restraints

<https://www.trafikverket.se/resa-och-trafik/trafiksakerhet/sakerhet-pa-vag/sakerhet-i-bil/saten-och-huvudstod/>

Syllabus self-assessment, chapter 2 §3

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/TSFS/TSFS%202011_20.pdf